



SUMMER INTERNSHIP REPORT

CRY: Child Rights and You, partnered with SAKSHAM NGO

Duration: 11th June – 26th July 2025

Location: Saket, Delhi

Topic:

Child Development and Community-Based Child Rights Practices

Agency Guide: Ms Savita, Manager of interns at CRY
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Acknowledgment

I would like to extend my profound gratitude to everyone who provided support and guidance during my internship with CHILD RIGHTS AND YOU (CRY), in partnership with Saksham NGO; for providing me with the opportunity to be a part of their impactful internship program. This experience has been both enriching and enlightening, allowing me to witness and contribute to grassroots-level development work.

I am deeply appreciative of the guidance and cooperation extended to me by Prof. Naseem Ahmad Khan, and the Departmental Training and Placement Head, Dr. Mohammad Tahir. Their encouragement and advice played a significant role in facilitating my internship.

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I am grateful to the entire team at Saksham NGO and CRY. Their collective expertise, resources, and unwavering assistance were instrumental in enriching my internship experience. The insights and encouragement I received from each team member deepened my understanding of the organization's mission and shaped my role as an intern. I am particularly appreciative of their constant support, patience, and readiness to address my inquiries throughout my time with the organization.

Lastly, I want to emphasize how this internship has profoundly enriched my understanding of child rights, child development, and child education. The hands-on experience I gained while working closely with both the Saksham NGO and CRY teams has deepened my commitment to advocating for these critical issues. The practical knowledge and insights I acquired in the field have broadened my perspective and reinforced the importance of community engagement in driving meaningful change.

This experience has been pivotal in shaping my professional aspirations, and I am truly grateful for the opportunity to contribute to such a significant cause.

About The Organisation

CRY – Child Rights and You is a leading Indian nongovernmental organization working to ensure the rights of underprivileged children. Founded in 1979 by Rippan Kapur, CRY has grown into a nationally recognized movement advocating for children's health, education, protection, and participation. CRY's vision is “a happy, healthy, and creative childhood for every child”. Its mission is to enable people to take responsibility for the situation of underprivileged children and motivate them to seek resolution through individual and collective action.

CRY works through a partnership model by supporting grassroots-level NGOs like Saksham. Rather than running its own schools or shelters, CRY strengthens community-based organizations to create sustainable, long-term change.

Key Areas of Work:

Education: Ensuring access to quality, uninterrupted education for every child.

Health & Nutrition: Focusing on early childhood care, immunization, and combating malnutrition.

Child Protection: Addressing issues like child labor, trafficking, abuse, and early marriage.

Participation: Promoting platforms for children to express their views and take part in decisions that affect them.

CRY operates across India, with field interventions in urban slums, rural villages, and marginalized tribal regions. It works in close collaboration with families, communities, volunteers, local bodies, and government departments. The organization also conducts research, campaigns, and policy advocacy to influence systemic change and make child rights a priority in public discourse. Through its work, CRY has brought lasting impact to the lives of over 3 million children and continues to strive toward a more just and inclusive society where every child has a fair chance at life.

Placement Site

Shahbad Dairy, Delhi

Shahbad Dairy, located in northwest Delhi's Rohini region, is home to over a hundred thousand residents and more than 21,000 families, most of whom migrated from states such as Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, and Jharkhand. It is a high-density, low-income settlement with deeply rooted vulnerabilities, insufficient basic infrastructure, crowded housing, limited sanitation, and recurring safety risks, especially for women and children.

A lack of proper toilets forced many residents, including families with young girls and children, to venture into unsafe forested areas at night, leading to tragic incidents of child abduction, assault, and disappearance. In this environment of daily survival and risk, schooling and upward mobility often take a back seat.

The partnership of **Saksham** and **CRY**: Based in Shahbad Dairy, Saksham centers its work on child protection, education access, and social justice advocacy: from rescuing missing children to fighting against early marriage. Supported by CRY, the organization has helped catalyze community leadership, especially among girls and young women.

In Shahbad Dairy today, children who were once invisible in statistics: missing, undernourished, or out of school, are stepping into boundary lines and classrooms with renewed purpose.. Education and public-health interventions, led by Saksham and supported by CRY, complement this process, ensuring that children grow not only healthy but as empowered individuals equipped to rewrite the story of their community.

This partnership underscores how strategic, grassroots-driven work (centered on children's rights, dignity, and opportunity) can reshape futures. For the youth of Shahbad Dairy, community-centered education is helping carve a path toward safety, visibility, and possibility they once thought was out of reach.



WEEK 1 (Orientation & Rapport Building)

Internship Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

12th June to 18th June 2025

During the first week of the internship, the interns participated in orientation sessions at CRY's main office, led by Ms. Smriti, the interns' manager and Ms Savita. These interactive sessions were designed to familiarize us with CRY's mission, values, and the scope of their work across different regions. Ms. Smriti provided us with a detailed history of CRY, outlining the key programs and initiatives currently running under the organization, with a focus on child rights, women empowerment, and educational development. She also explained CRY's collaboration with Saksham NGO, highlighting how this partnership has been crucial in promoting both child development and women's education. The orientation also included an overview of the various fieldwork we would be engaged in, specifically at Saksham NGO- Shahbad Dairy. This foundational knowledge set the tone for the rest of the internship, giving us a clear understanding of CRY's impact on the communities they serve.

ORGANISATIONAL PROFILING

CRY – Child Rights and You is a non-profit organization founded in 1979 by Rippan Kapur, an Indian Airlines purser, along with six friends and a modest fund of Rs. 50. Over more than four decades, CRY has grown into one of India's most recognized child rights organizations.

Vision: "A happy, healthy and creative child whose rights are protected and honoured in a society that is built on respect for dignity, justice and equity for all."

Mission: Taking Responsibility: To enable people to take responsibility for the situation of the deprived Indian child and motivate them to seek resolution through individual and collective action— ultimately enabling children to realise their full potential.

Why CRY Focuses on Children: Children are considered the building blocks of the nation's future. CRY believes that investing in children today will create the leaders, educators, and change-makers of tomorrow—our scientists, politicians, athletes, and artists.

Areas of Work

As shown in their key programmatic focus areas, CRY addresses critical issues affecting children's well-being:

- Child Education
- Child Health & Nutrition
- Stop Child Labour
- Support Girl Child Education
- Stop Child Marriage
- Prevent Child Trafficking
- STEM Education

These areas are aligned with CRY's commitment to ensuring that all children enjoy their fundamental rights without discrimination.

Scale of Impact

- Works with 102 local NGOs
- Present across 19 states in India
- Has impacted the lives of over 3 million children

Global Presence

CRY has international support operations in:

- United States (US)
- United Kingdom (UK)

This global presence helps amplify the voices of underprivileged children and garners financial and advocacy support from individuals and corporations worldwide.

Awards & Recognition

CRY's work has earned widespread recognition over the years, including:

- ET Shark Awards (2021) – Best Campaign in Communication
- Best Non-Profit Campaign (Silver, 2021) – “Don’t Help Children”
- Best Campaign in Not-For-Profit (Silver, 2024)
- Most Trusted NGO (2018) Quality Initiative Mission Award (2013)

COMMUNITY PROFILING

- **Name of the Community/Village:** Shahbad Dairy
- **Block:** Rohini
- **District:** North-West Delhi
- **State & Country:** Delhi, India

POPULATION

- **Population Count (Number):** Over 100,000
- **Number of Families:** Approx. 21,000
- **Demographic Analysis:** High-density slum-resettlement colony; population steadily growing due to migration and urban sprawl.
- **Religious Ratio:** Predominantly Hindu and Muslim populations; presence of both temples and mosques.

HISTORY

- **History of the Region:** Initially a rural area, Shahbad Dairy transformed into an urban settlement due to resettlement drives.
- **History of the Community:** Established over 25 years ago as a relocation site for displaced families from various unauthorized colonies in Delhi.
- **History of Political Ruling:** Dominated by AAP and BJP in recent years. Political presence remains strong during civic elections.

HOUSING

- **Type:** Mixed; majority Pucca houses with scattered Kachcha dwellings.
- **Belongingness:** Majority are owner-occupied with some rented accommodations.
- **Plot Size:** Typically small; congested lanes and closely packed houses.
- **Cost/Value:** Lower-income segment housing; informal valuation due to unregulated ownership.
- **Built Quality:** Generally poor to average; many homes lack ventilation and drainage systems.

ECONOMY

- **Employment (%):** Estimated over 60% employed (mostly informal sector).
- **Unemployment (%):** Approx. 30–40% due to lack of skilled opportunities.
- **Type of Employment:** Daily wage labor, e-rickshaw drivers, ragpickers, small vendors, domestic workers, and small eateries.

EDUCATION

- **Schools (Number):** Several schools including government and private.
- **Primary Schools:** 2–3 (e.g., Sarv Shiksha Abhiyan Branch)
- **Secondary Schools:** 2 (e.g., St. Xavier's School)
- **Further/Higher Education:** Nearby colleges include Delhi School of Professional Studies & Research.
- **Qualifications:** Basic education common; higher education limited due to economic constraints.
- **Attitudes Towards Education:** Mixed; growing awareness with active NGO involvement (e.g., CRY).
- **Distance of Schools:** Most within 1–2 km range

CRIME

- **Statistics:** High incidence of petty thefts, substance abuse, and gender-based violence. Active Police involvement.

HEALTH

- **Health Centres (Number):** At least 3 major centers.
- **Type:**
 - MH Shahbad Daulatpur (Govt.)
 - MCW Shahbad Daulatpur (Govt.)
 - Children & Maternity Centre (Public/NGO)
- **Distance:** Within 0.5 to 1.5 km for most residents.

FACILITIES & RESOURCES

- **Key Agencies:** NGOs such as CRY, Saksham, Sightsavers; informal CBOs.
- **Community Development Team:** Mostly NGO-led initiatives.
- **Leisure Facilities:** Limited public parks (e.g., B-Block Park, Joggers Park).
- **Shopping:** Local markets and general stores (e.g., Sahbad Dairy Market, Murga Market).
- **Worship:** Numerous temples and mosques including Kali Mata Mandir, Tayyaba Jama Masjid.
- **Library:** No public library known; educational NGOs may provide learning spaces.

PHYSICAL ENVIRONMENT

- **Size:** Large and densely populated settlement.
- **Ward Boundaries:** Falls under multiple urban wards in Rohini; governance under North Delhi Municipal Corporation.
- **Attitudes:**
 - Workers: Often migratory, hard-working, seeking stable employment.
 - Residents: Resilient, community-dependent, wary of authorities.
 - Non-residents: View area as unsafe; stigmatized due to crime and poverty.
- **Environmental Issues:** Poor drainage, garbage accumulation, air and water pollution

TRANSPORT

- **Personal/Private:** E-rickshaws, cycles, motorcycles common.
- **Public Transport:** Buses frequent; nearest railway stations are Khera Kalan and Badli.

- **Availability & Cost:** Moderate; affordable but not always reliable or safe.
- **Type of Road:** Predominantly Pucca, but narrow and poorly maintained internal roads.

NEEDS ANALYSIS

- Improved sanitation and sewage management
- Awareness on Substance Abuse
- Women's safety and public lighting
- Skill development programs for youth
- Access to clean drinking water
- Strengthening of public healthcare infrastructure

ABOUT SAKSHAM NGO

Project Office: Shahbad Dairy, Prahladpur, Delhi – 42 Area Office: Rohini Sector-5, Bhagwan Mahavir Road, Delhi – 85

Email: saksham.del1@gmail.com

Operational Areas: Saksham works in several localities including:

- Shahbad Dairy
- Prahladpur Bangar
- Prem Nagar
- Swaroop Nagar
- Sultanpuri
- Mangolpuri
- Budh Vihar
- Vijay Vihar
- Kirari
- Suleman Nagar
- Rohini Sector 28 & 5

Core Activities and Programs:

- **CAC (Child Activity Center) Operations**
 - Locations: Shahbad Dairy, Sultanpuri, Swaroop Nagar
 - Timings:
 - Morning: 9:00 AM to 11:30 AM
 - Afternoon: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM
- **CAC Digital Classes for Children**
 - Days: Monday to Friday
 - Timing: Same as CAC hours
- **CAC Life Skill Sessions for Children**
 - Conducted weekly within CAC schedule
- **DLC (Digital Learning Center)**
 - Areas: Swaroop Nagar and Prem Nagar
 - Timing: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM
- **Cricket Practice (With Umeed Foundation)**
 - Location: Swaroop Nagar
 - Days: Monday, Tuesday
 - Time: 2:30 PM to 5:00 PM
- **Digital Literacy Program**
 - Duration: 3–5 days or up to 2 weeks
 - For local adolescents and children
- **Women Empowerment Program – Shahbad Dairy**
 - Focused on:
 - Women's health and hygiene
 - Menstrual awareness
 - Safety awareness
 - Legal rights and leadership building
 - Location: A-1 Gupta Colony, Bengali Gali, Prahladpur Bangar
- **Self-Defense Training**
 - Weekly sessions on Saturdays and Sundays
 - Timing: 3:00 PM to 5:00 PM

Other Activities:

- **Legal Literacy and Awareness**
 - Topics: Police procedure, FIR filing, child rights, juvenile justice
 - Conducted with experts and legal professionals
- **Career Counseling & Vocational Training**
 - Support based on need and situation
 - Includes motivational sessions, goal setting, and parent engagement

Regular Events and Campaigns:

- **Cultural Events:** Annual Day, Diwali, Independence Day, Children's Day
- **Awareness Campaigns:** Education, child protection, health, environment, menstrual health
- **Sports Activities:** Competitions and training
- **Creative Engagement:** Drawing, slogan writing, essay competitions, digital art

Snapshots from week 1



WEEK 2

(Conducted Case Stories From Saksham's Cricket Club)

Internship Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

19th June to 25th June 2025

During Week 2, the trainees engaged in the detailed documentation of case stories of 18 students plus their coach, who are active participants in the Saksham Cricket Club. The primary goal was to understand the background, challenges, and transformations experienced by these children through their involvement in cricket, and to highlight the role of CRY and Saksham in shaping these journeys. A document of 32 pages including the individual case stories and a think piece on the impact of sports & athletics on the children of Shahbad Dairy was written.

Methodology:

- **Interviews and Conversations** with the children were conducted.
- **Themes Explored:** Family background, socio-economic vulnerabilities, initial challenges in accessing cricket, support systems, current participation, and personal development.

Key Insights from the Case Stories:

- **Socio-Economic Background:**
 - Most children come from **low-income households** where parents work as daily wage laborers, domestic workers, or in informal jobs.
 - Several children live in **single-parent households**, or large families with multiple siblings, resulting in **financial stress** and limited individual attention.
 - Domestic responsibilities—especially for girls—often compete with their time for sports and study

- **Barriers to Participation:** The children faced various challenges in joining or continuing with cricket:
 - **Financial Constraints:** Inability to afford gear, kits, shoes, or travel expenses.
 - **Lack of Equipment:** Many relied on borrowed bats and gloves or shared gear.
 - **Parental Resistance:** Concerns over safety, distraction from academics, or cultural hesitance toward girls in sports were common.
 - **Household Responsibilities:** Chores, caregiving, and tuition classes often clashed with training schedules.

- **Interventions and Support Systems:**
 - **Saksham and CRY's Role:** Provided cricket kits, regular coaching, structured practice schedules, and emotional encouragement.
 - **Peer Encouragement:** Older players mentored juniors, fostering confidence and camaraderie.
 - **Parental Engagement:** Coaches and volunteers counseled hesitant parents, gradually building trust.
 - **Alternative Pathways:** In some cases, cricket served as a second chance, offering purpose and identity when academic options were limited.

- **Impact and Transformation:** Cricket emerged as more than a sport—it became a platform for self-expression, resilience, and leadership. Key areas of positive change included:
 - **Increased Self-Confidence:** Many students reported feeling more respected and seen in their communities.
 - **Discipline and Time Management:** Children learned to balance academics, household work, and training through structured routines.
 - **Academic Focus:** They reflected improved study habits, often attributing this to the discipline learned from cricket.
 - **Social Skills and Empowerment:** Boys and girls both expressed how their interactions in mixed training groups fostered respect, teamwork, and emotional growth.

- **Aspirations:** Many now dream of professional cricket careers, while others see themselves as future coaches, umpires, or leaders.
- **Selected Highlights:**
 - **Nikki**, team captain, overcame financial and parental hurdles to become a role model and mentor for younger girls.
 - **Mansi**, despite emotional neglect from her family, found meaning in coaching and earning through cricket.
 - **Payal and Chetna** shared powerful accounts of defying gender norms and societal expectations through their consistent presence on the field

Ground Visit and Match Observation

The trainees also conducted a field visit to the local ground where the Saksham team practices and plays matches. A friendly match was observed, and detailed notes were taken on the players' interactions and performance. Key Observations Included:

Training Structure: Coaches were seen following a structured training routine, including warm-up exercises, drills, and practice matches. Their approach encouraged participation, discipline, and teamwork.

Player Engagement: The children displayed high energy levels, strong coordination, and mutual encouragement. Their enthusiasm and sportsmanship reflected the effectiveness of the program.

Social Impact of Sports: The visit provided deeper insight into how sports serve as a powerful tool for social and personal empowerment at the grassroots level. The inclusive and disciplined environment fostered by the program played a vital role in shaping the children's growth.

Reflection: This week provided the trainees with valuable experiences in understanding how structured sports initiatives like Saksham can positively influence underprivileged children. By collecting case stories and observing the program in action, a clearer picture emerged of how sports can be leveraged to promote development, resilience, and confidence among youth.

Case Stories

As written in the report submitted by the intern to their CRY Supervisor Ms. Savita (2 of 19)

Mansi - Quiet Persistence and Unseen Effort: Chasing the Game Without Applause

Mansi, an 18-year-old cricket trainee from Shahbad Dairy, carries a quiet sense of purpose shaped by personal discipline and a growing passion for the game. Her entry into cricket didn't come from within her home—no one in her family has played or followed the sport, and even now, their support remains limited. While not openly discouraged, Mansi often feels the absence of emotional encouragement. Her family's response to her involvement in cricket is mostly neutral—a simple “okay, go if you're going” rather than active interest or engagement. She admits that this lack of acknowledgment can feel disheartening. What she desires most is not material support, but the presence and validation that might come from something as small as her parents attending a match. That, she feels, would deepen her passion and help her perform with more heart.

Despite this emotional gap, Mansi maintains a structured daily routine. She wakes up at 5:30 a.m. to open the family's small general store, holding responsibility until her father takes over by 7:30. After this, she helps with basic household tasks. Being the youngest in the family, she's not burdened with extensive chores, which gives her more time to focus on her practice sessions. While academics never held her interest strongly, she has always been drawn toward physical activity and spent five years playing Handball before shifting her attention to cricket. Her connection with the sport began through a friend, and since then, she has developed steadily as a player.

Though she only began playing cricket last year, Mansi has already gained a range of experiences that extend beyond just practicing on the field. She has travelled to places like Chandigarh, Haridwar, and Shimla, where she assisted in match scoring—an opportunity that not only exposed her to competitive environments but also helped her earn a modest income. She also coaches younger children in cricket, a responsibility that

brings her both pride and a small stipend. However, this part-time coaching sometimes overlaps with her own training hours, presenting a challenge in terms of time management.

Materially, Mansi has only been able to acquire a pair of pad-ups of her own; the rest of her cricket gear is provided by Saksham. She expresses deep gratitude for this support, recognizing that without it, her journey in cricket might not have been possible. She trains with dedication and is focused on improving her skills, driven more by internal motivation than external encouragement. Her goal is to play cricket professionally in the future, and she also has a strong interest in coaching, hoping one day to guide other young players—particularly girls who, like her, may not receive full support at home.

Mansi has a clear message for the parents of girls who want to pursue sports: she urges them to be open, brave, and generous in their support. She believes that even small acts of encouragement can have a lasting impact. Drawing inspiration from the story of the Phogat sisters and their father who coached and supported them against the odds, she emphasizes how family involvement can shape not only an athlete's success but also their confidence and self-belief.

Her story, while shaped by the absence of consistent support, is also marked by her independence, resilience, and growing vision for herself in cricket. Mansi's journey reflects how even without a strong foundation of encouragement at home, a young person can build something meaningful when given opportunity, structure, and belief—both in themselves and from the few around them who choose to step in.

Satyam - Bowling Past Boundaries: Focus and Fairness in a Shared Game

Satyam is a 14-year-old student in the 10th grade who lives in Shahbad Dairy with his parents and three siblings. As the youngest child in the family, Satyam has had the chance to observe and learn from his older siblings—especially his brother, who also plays cricket. His father works as a mason, and while the family doesn't have an abundance of resources, they are supportive of Satyam's interest in sports and his academic goals.

Satyam's connection with cricket began during the COVID-19 lockdown, when schools were closed and daily routines shifted dramatically. It was during this period that he came into contact with Saksham and first witnessed the girls from his area playing cricket with a sense of energy and determination. That sight left a strong impression on him. Watching the girls play with such focus and discipline inspired him to pick up the game himself. Since then, cricket has become an important part of his routine, identity, and aspirations.

He trains and plays regularly, often alongside the girls. There are sometimes friendly matches organized between boys and girls, and Satyam feels the shared training environment has helped build mutual respect among the players. His parents are supportive of his journey, and unlike many girls around him, he hasn't had to struggle for approval or permission to play. He owns a decent amount of personal equipment—pads, gloves, and a bat—which allows him to train more independently and consistently.

That said, Satyam acknowledges that his growth in the sport wasn't immediate. For the first five or six months after he started playing, he didn't notice much improvement in his performance. But with time, practice, and persistence, he began to see real progress in his game. Now, his skills are more refined, and his confidence on the field has grown. He attributes this to not just practice, but to developing a sincere attitude toward the sport.

Academically, Satyam is interested in mathematics—particularly geometry—which he finds logical and satisfying to solve. However, balancing his studies and cricket is not always easy. The demands of school, practice, and personal study often stretch his time thin, especially now that he is preparing for his board exams. Still, he tries to manage both areas with discipline and focus, believing that success in either requires consistent effort.

Satyam's outlook extends beyond his personal journey. He often reflects on the challenges girls face in accessing and participating in sports. He observes that many of the girls he trains with have to deal with added responsibilities at home, social disapproval, and lack of support from their families. While he recognizes the unfairness of these barriers, he also considers the fears parents may have for their daughters in today's world—especially regarding their safety. He believes this perspective, while sometimes restrictive, comes from a place of concern, not control. His view is that both understanding and change are needed: for families to trust their daughters more, and for girls to keep pushing forward with strength and focus.

Looking ahead, Satyam dreams of playing cricket professionally. He understands that talent alone is not enough—it must be matched with hard work, patience, and clarity. His message to others is to be passionate and serious about the sport, to train with purpose, and most importantly, to find the right balance between cricket and education.

Satyam's story reflects a thoughtful young player who not only values his own journey but is also sensitive to the broader environment around him. Through cricket, he has found direction and identity, and his grounded reflections suggest that he will carry both the game—and the values it teaches—far into his future.

Snapshots from Week 2



WEEK 3

DELHI SARVAJANIK SHAUCHALYA SURVEY- 2025

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

26th June – 2nd July 2025

As part of the Delhi Sarvajanik Shauchalya Survey – 2025, the trainees conducted a systematic assessment of public and private toilet facilities located in Blocks A, B, and E of the Shahabad Dairy area. These blocks fall under the supervision of Saksham NGO, which facilitated access and coordination for the fieldwork. As part of the Delhi Sarvajanik Shauchalya Survey – 2025, the trainees carried out a structured and observational assessment of public and private toilet facilities across Blocks A, B, and E of Shahabad Dairy. These areas fall under the jurisdiction of Saksham NGO, which guided the trainees throughout the field activity. The process was conducted in the following steps:

- The trainees were introduced to the objectives and scope of the survey. They were briefed on the official format provided for the Shauchalya Survey, which served as the central framework for data collection. The format included specific indicators such as:
 - Number of seats for male and female users
 - Water availability
 - Electricity connection
 - Functional condition of doors and locks
 - Presence of CCTV and complaint redressal information
 - Availability of dustbins
 - Drainage condition and general maintenance

These indicators were crucial for ensuring standardization and comparability across different sites.

- **Field Visit and On-Site Observation:** The trainees physically visited multiple toilet units—both government-run and privately managed—located within the selected blocks. Observations were made in real-time during peak usage hours to ensure accurate assessment of user experience and facility conditions.
- **Focused Observational Parameters:** In addition to the standard survey format, the trainees also paid close attention to key human-centric and gender-sensitive factors, including:
 - Adequacy and reliability of lighting, especially in women's sections
 - Privacy and safety conditions, including functioning latches and enclosed spaces
 - Cleanliness and hygiene levels in and around the washrooms
 - Availability of soap and sanitary pads
 - Presence of foul odor, stagnant water, or pest infestation
- **User Feedback Collection:** To enrich the findings, the trainees conducted informal interviews and conversations with users, including men, women, and children, to understand satisfaction levels, concerns, and suggestions for improvement. This qualitative input added depth to the numerical data collected via the form.
- **Data Recording and Compilation:** Each toilet unit was assessed individually. Information was recorded as per the survey sheet and supplemented with observational notes and user quotes. Data was then compiled block-wise for comparative analysis of private versus government-managed facilities.

By combining standardized form-based data collection with groundlevel observation and community interaction, the trainees ensured a comprehensive and user-oriented understanding of the sanitation conditions in Shahabad Dairy.

Transect Walk – Shahabad Dairy (Block A), New Delhi

As part of the trainees on-ground learning experience during the internship, the trainees participated in a transect walk through the inner lanes of Block A, Shahabad Dairy, New Delhi. This activity was facilitated by our resource person Ayesha, a local field leader and team member from Saksham NGO. The purpose of the walk was to engage directly with the community

environment, observe the infrastructure and living conditions, and understand the spatial and social challenges faced by residents on a daily basis. Rather than being a conventional data collection exercise, the walk served as a powerful learning tool to connect policy with lived experience.

Key Observations from the Walk:

- **Extremely Narrow Lanes:** The streets were tightly packed, making mobility difficult, especially for emergency services and sanitation vehicles.
- **Inadequate Street Lighting:** Many areas lacked sufficient lighting, raising concerns about safety, particularly for women and children during the evening hours.
- **Lack of Public Spaces:** There was no common community area for recreation, gatherings, or children's play, contributing to a lack of safe, shared environments.
- **Problematic Water Infrastructure:** Water supply pipes were observed to run alongside open drains (nala), raising serious concerns about contamination and health risks.
- **Overcrowded Living Conditions:** Homes were small and congested, with multiple family members often sharing a single room. Ventilation and privacy were severely limited.
- **Water Dependency and School Absenteeism:** A government-provided water tank was seen as the main water source for many families. Trainees learned that children often miss school to queue for water collection, affecting their education.
- **Poor Water Quality:** The water from the tank was reportedly smelly and yellow, raising concerns over potability and sanitation.
- **Education Deprivation:** A notable number of children were observed roaming the streets during school hours, indicating both low school attendance and limited parental or systemic support for education.

Reflection and Learning: This walk was more than an observational task—it was an eye-opening experience. It brought to light the urgent need for community-focused development, where basic rights like water, sanitation, safety, and education are still inaccessible for many. We are especially grateful for the insights shared by Ms. Anjali and Mr. Pratik, community members who narrated the day-to-day struggles and invisible burdens that residents, especially children and women, carry. This experience reaffirmed that policies must be rooted in ground realities,

Survey Format

Snapshots from week 3



WEEK 4

Community Outreach for CAC Admissions

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

3rd July – 9th July 2025

During Week 4, the trainees, along with students of the Child Activity Center (CAC) and under the guidance of Miss Ayesha, conducted a community outreach initiative in the Shahabad Dairy locality. The objective of this activity was to identify eligible children aged 9 to 18 years and encourage their enrollment in Saksham's Child Activity Center.

Process Followed:

Door-to-Door Visits: The team visited multiple households in the locality, interacting directly with parents and guardians to gather information about children who were either out of school, irregular in attendance, or lacked access to academic support.

Awareness and Counseling: The trainees explained the purpose and benefits of the CAC (Child Activity Center). They emphasized that the program is completely free of cost, and is designed to bridge educational gaps and enhance learning opportunities for underprivileged children.

Key Features Highlighted:

- Free education support for school-going children
- English language classes to build communication skills
- Access to a Digital Learning Center, where children are introduced to basic computer literacy, typing skills, and safe internet use
- A safe and structured learning environment to encourage consistent engagement and reduce drop-out risk

Community Response: Parents expressed appreciation for the initiative, particularly those who were unable to afford tuition fees or lacked the time to assist their children with schoolwork.

Some families were unaware of the CAC's services, and the outreach helped create new awareness about the opportunities available through Saksham NGO.

In several cases, the trainees had to address concerns about safety, timing, and curriculum, and offered reassurance through examples of successful students currently attending CAC.

Snapshots from week 4



WEEK 5

Interaction with Mahila Group Members

Organization: CRY (Child Rights and You)

Location: Shahabad Dairy, Delhi

10th July – 16th July 2025

During Week 5, the trainees had the opportunity to meet and engage in a group discussion with the Mahila Group—a network of women from Shahabad Dairy who are actively connected with Saksham NGO. These women serve as community monitors and first responders in cases involving domestic violence, female foeticide, and missing children.

Understanding the Role of the Mahila Group: The Mahila Group members play a vital role in ensuring local accountability and early intervention within the community. They are not formally employed staff, but empowered local women trained and supported by Saksham to act as vigilant citizens and advocates for women and child protection.

They shared with the trainees that: Many women from the locality approach them directly to report abuse, often because they feel safer confiding in someone from within the community rather than going to the police or outside agencies. Upon receiving a complaint—particularly of domestic violence—members personally visit the household to check on the condition of the woman or child involved.

They look for signs of ongoing abuse, such as emotional withdrawal, physical injuries, or fear, and intervene when necessary, sometimes by facilitating counseling or referring the case to the NGO for legal or institutional support.

Key Insights from the Interaction:

- The group revealed that cases of domestic violence are on the rise, with many incidents going unreported due to stigma, fear of retaliation, or financial dependence on the abuser.

- They emphasized that their continued presence in the community builds trust, which is why many women confide in them before approaching external help.
- In cases involving missing children, the group helps alert local authorities and spread word through community networks.
- Female foeticide—while less visible—remains a concern in some areas, especially when families react negatively to news of a girl child.

Visit to Saksham Anganwadi Poshadh – Block F, Shahabad Dairy

The trainees visited the Saksham Anganwadi Poshadh Kendra located in Block F of Shahabad Dairy. This Anganwadi center operates under the “*Mahila evam Baal Vikas Vibhag*” (Department of Women and Child Development) and is supported by Saksham NGO.

The session was guided by **Ms Reshma**, the designated resource person at the center, who provided the trainees with an overview of the center's functions, beneficiaries, and its role in supporting early childhood development and maternal health in the community.

Key Areas of Learning from the Visit:

- **Services and Facilities Provided:** Reshma explained that the Anganwadi provides a range of essential services to women and children, including:
 - Supplementary nutrition for pregnant and lactating women, as well as for children under 6 years of age.
 - Early childhood care and pre-school education, focusing on foundational literacy, hygiene habits, and cognitive development through songs, storytelling, and basic learning tools.
 - Immunization support in collaboration with local health workers (ASHA/ANM).
 - Health check-ups and referrals for mothers and children.
 - Awareness programs on topics such as nutrition, child rights, hygiene, and gender equality.
- **Nutrition and "Poshadh" Distribution:** The center regularly distributes nutritional food packets (Poshadh) which include items such as dry ration, ready-to-eat meals, and

iron/calcium supplements for women and children. Reshma emphasized that this support is crucial for families facing food insecurity and malnourishment concerns.

- **Community Engagement and Challenges:** The Anganwadi staff often conduct home visits to identify new beneficiaries, especially in underserved pockets of the locality. However, challenges such as irregular attendance, misinformation, and lack of awareness among some parents remain ongoing issues. She also mentioned how Saksham supports the Anganwadi through volunteer assistance, outreach drives, and ensuring that mothers receive correct information about available schemes and services.

Snapshots from week 5



WEEK 6

Interaction with Slum Children & Teaching and Assisting at the Child Activity Center (CAC)

Organization: *CRY (Child Rights and You)*

Location: *Shahabad Dairy, Delhi*

17th July – 23rd July 2025 During

Week 6, the trainees participated in informal engagement with children living in the slum settlements of Shahabad Dairy. The aim was not just observation, but to build rapport, better understand the children's mindset, and encourage them toward education.

Highlights of the Interaction:

- Many children were seen playing or wandering unsupervised during school hours. A significant number of them had either dropped out of school or never enrolled.
- When asked why they weren't attending school, common responses included:
 - "I have to help at home."
 - "I don't like school; I can't understand what they teach."
 - "We don't have books or uniforms."
- The trainees also spoke with children who had siblings attending tuition or CAC, which became an entry point for conversation.
- Children were encouraged to visit the CAC center, where they could learn in a fun, pressure-free environment. A few expressed interest and agreed to visit.

Reflection: This experience emphasized the importance of relationship-building and patience in community engagement. These children are not just victims of poverty, but also of disinterest, neglect, or cultural barriers toward education. The interaction reinforced the belief that change begins with consistent presence, empathy, and trust—not just formal intervention.

Teaching and Assisting at the Child Activity Center (CAC)

In Week 6, the trainees also took an active teaching role at the CAC center, supporting academic and non-academic learning sessions for children aged 9–18.

Nature of Involvement:

- Trainees helped facilitate basic academic sessions, including Hindi, English, and Mathematics.
- One-on-one support was provided to children struggling with reading and writing, especially those who had dropped out and were re-entering learning after long gaps.
 - The trainees also organized interactive learning activities, including:
 - Spelling games and storytelling in English
 - Basic counting and mental math sessions
 - Drawing and general knowledge quizzes to enhance participation

Reflection: Teaching at CAC was a hands-on experience in alternative education delivery. It made trainees aware of the gaps in formal schooling, especially for marginalized children, and the importance of flexible, student-centered approaches. It also instilled a deeper respect for the work of grassroots educators who sustain motivation in children despite difficult circumstances.

Snapshots from week 6



OBSERVATIONS

- **Unreliable Water Supply:** The intern observed that the government-provided water at community taps and household connections was frequently yellowish and emitted a strong odor. Many families collected water reluctantly, often testing its smell before filling containers.
- **Decrepit Public Sanitation:** During the transect walk and the Delhi Sarvajanik Shauchalya Survey, the intern noted that government toilets were overcrowded, poorly lit, and lacked soap or sanitary disposal facilities. Users often avoided these facilities after dusk due to fear of harassment.
- **Anganwadi Attendance Pattern:** At the Anganwadi in Block F, children consistently arrived around midday—precisely when Poshadh (mid-day meal) was served—but were absent during early-morning educational sessions, indicating attendance driven more by nutrition needs than by learning opportunities.
- **Spatial Congestion and Infrastructure Deficit:** The intern documented that the inner lanes of Shahbad Dairy were extremely narrow, with open drains running alongside housing units. Streetlights were sparse or non-functional, and mothers hesitated to use community paths with young children after sunset.
- **Children in Public Spaces during School Hours:** On multiple occasions, the intern encountered groups of boys and girls playing or loitering in open areas during school hours, suggesting widespread irregular attendance and minimal parental or institutional supervision.
- **Mixed-Gender and Cross-Community Interaction in Sports:** While observing the Saksham cricket practice, the intern saw boys and girls of diverse backgrounds train together without visible caste-based grouping, sharing equipment and encouraging each

other.

- **Caste Dynamics:** When the intern asked Saksham staff about caste relations in Shahbad Dairy, they became hesitant and diverted the conversation. On the ground, no overt segregation in the community was evident, yet seating during community meetings sometimes fell into subtle caste-based clusters.

ANALYSIS

The poor water quality in Shahbad Dairy reflects both *systemic infrastructural neglect* and the community's limited political influence. The intern infers that municipal authorities prioritize better-off neighborhoods for pipeline maintenance, leaving settlements like Shahbad Dairy with aging, corroded pipes. This dynamic not only poses daily health risks, but also erodes resident trust in public services, pushing families to depend on expensive private water vendors or unsafe alternative sources.

Inadequate sanitation facilities stem from chronic underfunding and low accountability. The intern's field survey revealed toilets that were not adequately cleaned and doors that lacked functional locks. The absence of basic hygiene supplies disproportionately affects women and girls, reinforcing gendered vulnerabilities: women avoid using facilities after dark for fear of assault, while girls may miss school during menstruation due to a lack of private, clean spaces. *This intersection of gender norms and infrastructure deficits deepens marginalization.*

The pattern of children attending Anganwadi centers only for the mid-day meal highlights food insecurity as a primary driver of participation. The intern believes that for many families, the guarantee of one nutritious meal outweighs the perceived value of early-learning activities, especially when daily survival is at stake.

Spatial congestion and the lack of safe communal spaces reflect broader urban planning failures in low-income settlements. Narrow lanes impede emergency services and exacerbate flood risks when drains overflow. The intern observed that children have no designated play areas, pushing them into traffic or unsafe vacant plots. *These infrastructural constraints underline how physical marginalization (poor roads, open drains) translates into social marginalization*, as families feel cut off from civic life and services.

The visible irregular school attendance among slum children is driven by several interlocking factors. Financial pressures compel many children to help with household chores or informal work. Moreover, the intern infers that poor quality of local government school dampens parental enthusiasm. When children said "I don't understand what they teach," it revealed both

pedagogical gaps and a cycle of disengagement that extends from the classroom into the community.

The *absence of overt caste segregation* in daily activities such as cricket practice, Saksham classes and school interactions suggests a pragmatic solidarity born of shared marginalization: migrants from Bihar, UP, and Jharkhand unite in navigating the hardships of urban poverty. Yet, the *hesitance* of Saksham functionaries to discuss caste reflects an unspoken recognition that caste identity still shapes social capital, marriage prospects, and intra-community hierarchies. By avoiding open dialogue on caste, NGOs may maintain surface cohesion but risk obscuring deeper inequalities that influence who accesses leadership roles or whose voices are centered in decision-making.

Finally, mixed-gender sports engagement in Saksham's Cricket Club emerged as a site of subtle social transformation. On the cricket field, the intern witnessed girls asserting themselves in ways they could not in domestic spaces, and boys learning to respect their female peers. This demonstrates how structured sports initiatives can circumvent gender norms; providing a neutral arena in which marginalised children gain confidence, leadership skills, and cross-community bonds that may gradually reshape broader social dynamics.

CHALLENGES FACED

Irregular Attendance of Children: At the CAC center and Anganwadi, many children were irregular. This made it difficult to plan consistent learning activities or track progress. It also revealed a lack of parental motivation or awareness about education.

Limited Infrastructure and Difficult Field Conditions: Narrow, congested lanes with poor lighting and drainage made field visits physically difficult and, at times, unsafe—especially during rain

Unhygienic Sanitation Conditions: Surveying public toilets was challenging due to extremely poor hygiene conditions, foul smell, and lack of cooperation from some users.

Emotional Impact of Sensitive Cases: Listening to stories of domestic violence, child neglect, or poverty was emotionally heavy. While trainees could not intervene directly, witnessing such realities left a strong emotional impact.

Time Constraints per Household Visit: While conducting CAC admissions or home visits, many parents were unavailable or busy during the day. This reduced the effectiveness of outreach in some areas.

Difficulty in Collecting Authentic Case Details: While documenting case stories of the cricket team, some children were shy or unable to articulate their experiences clearly. In a few cases, information was incomplete due to limited time or hesitation from the family.

Lack of Follow-Up Mechanisms: Some children or parents showed interest in joining CAC or participating in activities, but due to lack of systematic follow-up, they eventually dropped off or did not attend.

LEARNING OUTCOMES

Over the course of six weeks at CRY – Child Rights and You, in partnership with Saksham NGO, the internship offered an invaluable blend of field exposure, organizational understanding, and community engagement. The key learning outcomes were:

Practical Understanding of Child Rights Trainees developed a deep insight into ground-level implementation of child protection, education, health, and participation rights. The realworld challenges faced by children in urban slums provided a practical context to the academic knowledge of child rights frameworks.

Community Engagement and Outreach Skills Through door-to-door visits, slum interactions, and admissions drives, trainees learned how to communicate effectively with vulnerable populations, gain trust, and adapt their language and approach according to age, literacy level, and social background.

Exposure to Gender and Social Justice Issues Engagements with Mahila Group members and the observation of domestic violence, female foeticide, and educational neglect shed light on the intersection of gender, poverty, and marginalization. The trainees learned the importance of local women's leadership in social change.

Educational Support and Teaching at the Child Activity Center (CAC) helped trainees understand alternative learning methods for children with academic gaps. It improved their skills in lesson planning, individual attention, and creative pedagogy.

Survey and Field Research Competence Participation in the Delhi Sarvajanic Shauchalya Survey and transect walk trained the trainees in data collection, observation, and field analysis, especially in sanitation, infrastructure, and public health contexts.

Critical Thinking and Reflection Each interaction—whether with a child, a parent, or a community worker—invited trainees to think critically about policy gaps, systemic limitations, and the importance of grassroots-led development.

CONCLUSION

The internship with CRY and Saksham NGO at Shahabad Dairy was a transformative learning experience, blending theory with field reality. From observing sanitation systems to documenting the dreams of slum children, each week presented a new lens to view inequality, resilience, and the importance of community-based solutions.

Trainees witnessed firsthand how non-governmental organizations serve as bridges between policy and people, especially in under-resourced urban spaces. The exposure to diverse programs—such as the Cricket Team empowerment stories, CAC education model, digital learning, women's groups, and Anganwadi centers—allowed for a comprehensive understanding of how multi-dimensional development work happens.

One of the most powerful takeaways was the role of trust, presence, and consistency in creating meaningful change. Whether it was a child hesitant to join a class, a mother sharing her trauma, or a volunteer leading a sports session, every moment demonstrated that social change begins with dignity, dialogue, and local leadership.

This internship has not only enriched the trainees' understanding of child rights and development work but has also deepened their empathy, sharpened their field instincts, and strengthened their commitment to working toward a just and inclusive society.